(a) A base-model output that loops (Malay prompt; schematic, not to scale)



(b) Text before the training position

…Tetapi konteks di sini mengatakan "Perkhidmatan Feri Malaysia", mungkin merujuk…

"…But the context here says 'Malaysia Ferry Service', possibly referring to…" (occurrence 1)

…dimansuhkan pada tahun 1996. Tetapi soalan

"…was discontinued in 1996. But the question

Here the model wrote "mengatakan" (says), starting occurrence 2, and went on to repeat the sentence 21 times in total until the token cap.

(c) The training pair at that position

rejected mengatakan 'says': starts the repeat (base p = 0.32)

chosen bertanya menyebut ini tidak +12 more

asks mentions this not

FTPO raises each chosen logit above the rejected one by a margin, while a tether keeps every other logit close to the base model. Chosen tokens are the base model's own top-20 alternatives.